



akayza

Keep it in the kasi.

Igniting capabilities for South Africa's informal market.

Built for use by spaza shops, food sellers and builders, on the phones they already own.

Prepared by Team PR · GKHack26 · 27 September 2026



THE PROBLEM

Everyone wants a piece of the informal market



Big retailers are moving into townships



Banks and payment apps are fighting for its customers

Because it's worth about

R900 billion a year



A spaza shop, and its supplier's truck



A builder's site: bricks, cash and trust



The people who run it can't prove any of it



No finance

Savings, family 57%



Bank loan <9%



It runs on cash and word of mouth. 57% use savings and family; fewer than 9% can get a bank loan.



No support

Fund R500m



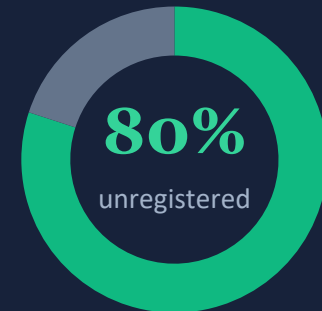
Reached shops
R179.6m



Of the R500m Spaza Shop Support Fund, R179.6m reached spaza shops. 354 applications failed verification.



No record



About 80% are unregistered: every order is cash, every dispute is word against word.

A spaza owner can't get stock on credit. A builder can't prove the houses he's built.





One free app for the whole informal market



Matched with suppliers who deliver

Spaza shops and food sellers order from the suppliers they use, and ones that fit them.



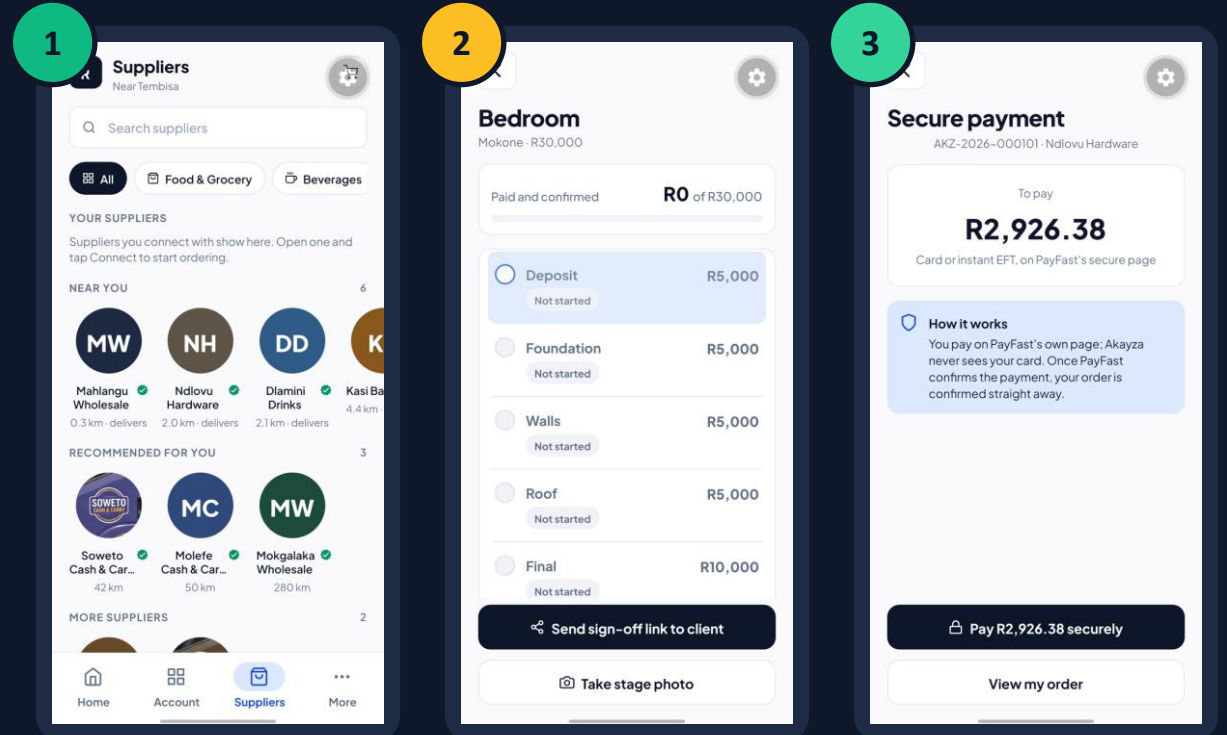
Every job logged with photos

Builders photograph each stage, and the client signs it off from a link.



Payments confirmed

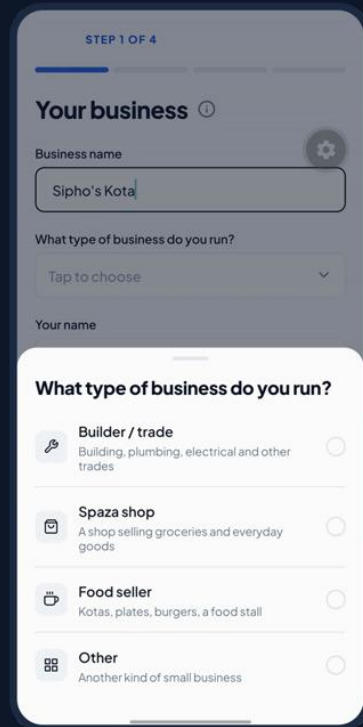
Paid in the app: confirmed by the payment provider. A job stage: confirmed by both sides.



Airtime advance, for business. Your network lends you airtime because it's seen that you always pay. Every paid order and signed-off job adds to a record the owner holds: the first step to credit, better suppliers and new clients.



Meet Sipho and Thabo



The screenshot shows a mobile app interface for business registration. At the top, it says 'STEP 1 OF 4'. Below that is a section titled 'Your business' with a help icon. There are three input fields: 'Business name' with the text 'Sipho's Kota', 'What type of business do you run?' with a dropdown menu showing 'Tap to choose', and 'Your name'. Below these fields is a list of business types with radio buttons: 'Builder / trade' (Building, plumbing, electrical and other trades), 'Spaza shop' (A shop selling groceries and everyday goods), 'Food seller' (Kotas, plates, burgers, a food stall), and 'Other' (Another kind of small business).

SIPHO · KOTA SHOP

Any kasi business.
Sipho picks Food seller.



SIPHO · KOTA SHOP

1. Picks Food seller and drops a pin where he trades
2. Finds suppliers who deliver to him
3. Orders bread and pays: PayFast confirms it
4. Sells kotas at the counter, in his order book
5. His record grows, confirmed payments marked

THABO · BUILDER

1. Photographs each stage of a job in the app
2. The client signs off from a link: confirmed by both
3. Finished jobs become his track record

Full video, 81 seconds: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1yYQfVBEG-dnn-hxgRRtD5xDVw8vZV8Es/view?usp=drive_link



Suppliers pay. We need R300,000.

Starter	R299 /month
Pro	R1,499 /month
ERP link	R4,999 /month + setup
Digital orders	~1% cash stays free

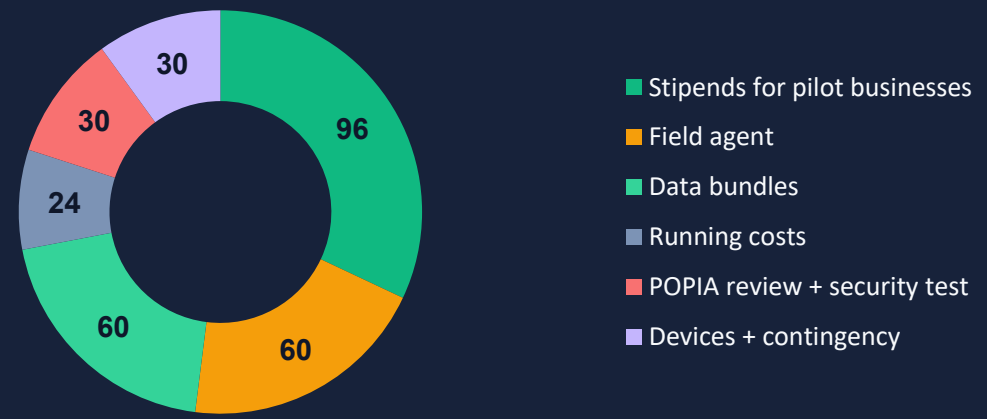
Businesses use it free. Next: lenders pay to see a business's record, only with the owner's consent.

Estimates: about R56,000 a month by the end of year 1, and R1.1 million a month by year 3.

Estimates. Commission assumes ~R4,000 of digital orders per business per month.

R300,000

for a 6-month pilot: the sum of its costs (R thousand)



2 suppliers and 50-100 businesses live · break-even at 2 suppliers on Starter (about R460 a month to run)



They sell to you. We build your record.

	Runs the business	Your own suppliers	Spaza shops and builders	A record the owner holds
WhatsApp + notebook (today)	no	by voice note	yes	a notebook
A wholesaler's own app (e.g. Shoprite Cash & Carry)	no	one wholesaler	shops	one supplier's orders
Payments / POS (iKhokha, Yoco)	sales only	no	yes	card sales
Bulk buying (Spazapp)	no	their range	shops	their orders
Akayza	yes	any supplier	yes	orders, jobs, payments

Payments are confirmed by the provider, job stages by both sides. And the record belongs to the owner: nothing goes to a lender without their consent.



In the 1950s, Richard Maponya started a milk business in Soweto. His customers trusted him, and decades later he opened Maponya Mall.

The next Maponya is out there right now.

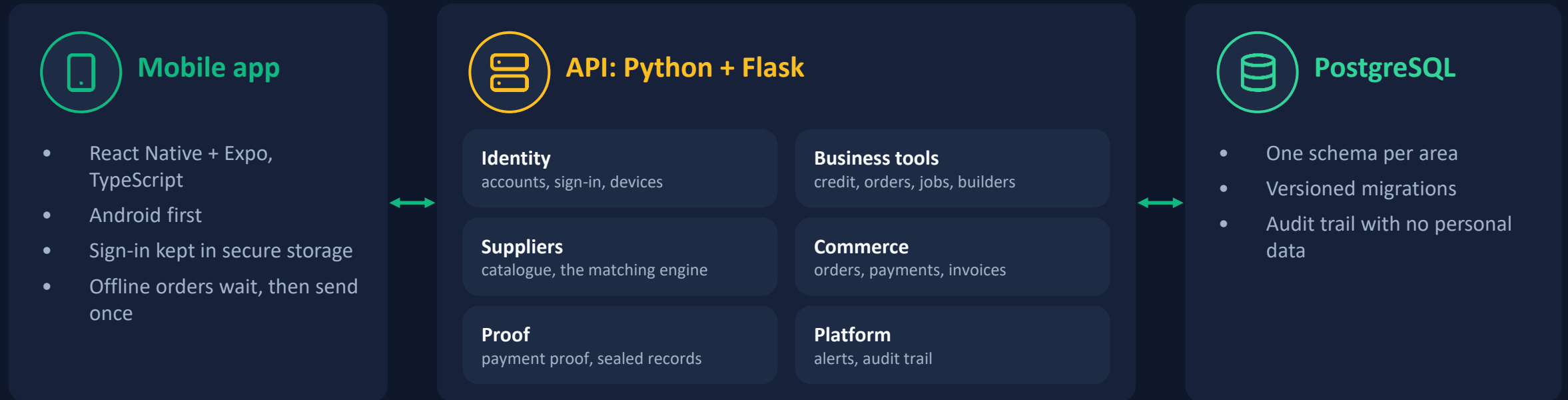
Selling kotas. Running a spaza. Laying bricks.

We don't hold the stock. We build the record.

Keep it in the kasi.

Thank you · R300,000 for a 6-month pilot · Team PR, GKHack26

How it's built



SERVICES WE USE



On every request: HTTPS, a signed-in token, only the owner's data (anyone else's is 'not found'), strict input checks, rate limits, no double orders, and the server sets every price. 1,281 backend and 204 app tests run before every merge.

Your data is yours. POPIA from day one.

What we collect, and why

- Email and password (stored hashed) to sign you in
- Business name, type and area the right tools and suppliers
- A CIPC number, only if you choose a badge, checked on the register
- Orders and payment results invoices, receipts and your record
- Your tools: credit book, jobs yours; suppliers never see it

What we never do

- ✗ Ask for an ID number or passport
- ✗ See or store card numbers
- ✗ Sell your data, or use it for ads
- ✗ Show your customers' names to suppliers

YOUR RIGHTS

See and download your data

On our server today; the app button is next

Close your account

In the app today; every phone is signed out

Delete your data

Next. Tax records stay 5 years, by law

If there's ever a breach

We tell you and the Information Regulator

